Vaibhav Nainwal

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Education

Delhi School of Economics, University of Delhi **2023 - 2025**

M.A. Economics, (CGPA 7.43/10)

- Relevant Coursework: Mathematics, Econometrics, Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Game Theory, Labour Economics, Monetary Theory and Policy, Development Economics, Public Economics

Shri Ram College of Commerce, University of Delhi **2020 - 2023**

Bachelor of Arts (Honours) - Economics (CGPA 8.90/10)

- Secured Rank 3 in Semester II, overall Rank 8 in first year in a batch of 205 students
- Scored a perfect 10 CGPA across 10 subjects, including Mathematical Methods for Economics, Statistics and Development Economics

Research Interests

Development Economics **Labour Economics** **Public Economics** **Inequality & Poverty**

Research Experience

Research Associate, CAFRAL, Reserve Bank of India **July 2025 - Present**

- Principal Investigator: **Professor Vidhya Soundararajan**
- Assisted on multiple research projects in labour economics, banking, and firm dynamics by supporting empirical research and data-driven analysis
- Conducted literature reviews and supported empirical research through web scraping, data cleaning, variable construction, and econometric analysis
- Contributed to RBI policy projects through drafting policy notes and presentations on labour market trends and MSME credit access

Research Intern, Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region **June 2024 - July 2024**

- Conducted quantitative and qualitative research, to prepare a report on "Banking Challenges in Northeast India" for the Economic and Financial Affairs Wing, subsequently presented to and approved by the Deputy Secretary
- Developed data-driven content for 'Bankers' Conclave' presentations, emphasizing digitization and rural credit in agriculture and MSMEs, providing actionable insights to drive informed discussions and decision-making
- Developed a comprehensive report identifying strategic trade opportunities between India and Bangladesh, providing actionable insights for bilateral growth and collaboration

Working Papers

Inflation Targeting, Monetary Policy Surprises, and Capital Misallocation

With Vidhya Soundararajan and Rajeswari Sengupta, IGIDR Working Paper

Summary: We examine whether a more predictable monetary policy framework improves the allocation of capital across firms. Using firm-level data from the Indian manufacturing sector for 2005-2024, we study this in the context of India's adoption of flexible inflation targeting (FIT) in 2015. We find that firms with high pre-FIT average revenue per unit of capital (ARPK) subsequently accumulate more capital and experience a relative decline in ARPK, consistent with capital being reallocated toward previously under-capitalized firms.

Work in Progress

Expanding Formal Credit for Micro Firms: Evidence from India's PSL Reform

Skills

Python(Advanced) **Stata(Advanced)** **R (Advanced)** **LaTeX**

Languages Spoken

English **Hindi** **Kumaoni**